

Head of Operations

at Acme Corp, Payments division

Candidate: Alex Morgan

Assessed: 2026-10-04

Model: Claude (illustrative fictional example)

80.4

Strong

core 67.5 adjusted 61.2 bonus
+19.25 (c11 6.25, c13 6, c14 7)

Core 67.5 -> adjusted 61.2 (star, gamma 1.25); total = clamp(adjusted + bonus, 0, 100) = clamp(61.2 + 19.25, 0, 100) = 80.4

Check before you apply

Application form questions that often reject within a day

- Salary expectation: state a figure inside the advertised band
- Notice period: state it exactly as your contract says
- Right to work: answer the question for the country of the role
- Current job title: enter the title on your CV, not an informal one
- Yes or no experience questions: answer from the JD requirements, since the CV cannot

Screening signals (c14) +7

- Time at the target seniority +5: Example Payments Ltd 2021-03 to present 68 months = 68 months (at least 3 years, threshold 36) = +5
- Employment gaps +0: no gap over 6 months between dated roles in the last 10 years = 0
- Short recent roles +0: two most recent roles: Example Payments Ltd 2021-03 to present 68 months; Northwind Bank 2017-01 to 2021-02 50 months; 0 under 12 months x -3 = 0
- Contract history +0: JD basis unknown, 0 contract signal(s): no effect = 0
- Phrases copied from the JD +0: 0 distinct run(s) of 6 or more words shared with the JD; first 3 free; max(-5, -1 x max(0, 0 - 3)) = 0
- Sector recency +2: current role (Example Payments Ltd 2021-03 to present) is in the JD sector = +2
- Conventional certifications +0: conventional certifications do not apply to this role family = 0
- Conflict of interest +0: no conflict of interest found = 0

Criteria

	Criterion	Score	Weight	Working
c1	Current or most recent role	60.5	50	weighted mean(title 100 (exact), headline 70 (close), same_industry 100, competitor 100, supplier 0, top_firm 0) = 60.48
c2	Employer strictness (BCG growth-share)	gamma 1.25	modifier	base 0.75 (star) + buzz 0 -> strictness clamp(0.75, 0.25, 1.25) = 0.75; gamma = 0.5 + 0.75 = 1.25; adjusted = 100 * (67.48/100)^1.25 = 61.16
c3	Years with the JD's tools and suppliers	66.7	5.56	mean(Salesforce: 94 months = 7.83 y / 5 y required = 100; ServiceNow: 118 months = 9.83 y / 3 y required = 100; Snowflake: 0 months = 0 y / 3 y required = 0) = 66.67
c4	AI experience and outcomes	60.8	5.56	breadth min(3/4,1)*50 = 37.5 + depth min(1/3,1)*30 = 10 + tenure min(2/3,1)*20 = 13.33 = 60.83
c5	Likelihood the CV was AI-generated	55.0	5.56	direction negative: 100 - likelihood 45 = 55 (an indication, not proof)
c6	Spelling	90.0	5.56	max(0, 100 - 5 * 2 spelling errors) = 90
c7	Grammar	90.0	5.56	max(0, 100 - 5 * 2 grammar errors) = 90
c8	STAR / Problem-Action-Result bullets	50.0	5.56	mean(6 full x 1, 10 partial x 0.5, 6 none x 0) over 22 achievement/experience bullets * 100 = 50 (3 other bullets not scored)
c9	Top university	80.0	5.56	tier russell_group = 80
c10	Qualifications against the JD	100.0	5.56	weighted mean(PMP certification met x2, Lean Six Sigma Green Belt or higher met x1) = 3/3 * 100 = 100
c12	Tenure against expected longevity	77.8	5.56	median of 4 completed tenures (50, 20, 26, 30 months) = 28 months / (3 y * 12 = 36) capped at 1 * 100 = 77.78; current role excluded
c13	Consulting experience (bonus)	+6	bonus	Globex Consulting (top_in_industry true, related_to_jd true) +6 = 6, capped at 10 = +6
c14	Screening signals (plus and minus points)	+7	bonus	seniority +5, gaps 0, short_recent 0, contract 0, echo 0, sector +2, certs 0, conflict 0 = +7

Strengths

- Same title, same industry and a direct competitor employer, so the current role is a very close match (c1).
- Holds the required PMP and the desirable Green Belt (c10).
- Salesforce and ServiceNow experience well beyond the years asked (c3).
- Several full situation-action-result bullets with numbers (c8).

Risks

- No Snowflake experience shown on the CV (c3).
- Only one AI use is quantified, so AI evidence is moderate (c4).
- Four spelling and grammar slips in a CV for a senior role (c6, c7).
- Several bullets describe duties with no result (c8) and some phrasing reads as stock AI wording (c5).

Actions

- Fix the two spelling errors and two grammar errors before applying (c6, c7).
- Add a result to the duty bullets, or cut them (c8).
- Add Snowflake or similar warehouse experience if true, for example via the Power BI reporting (c3).
- Quantify the fraud-alert and Copilot outcomes (c4).
- Replace "spearheaded" and "leveraged" phrasing with specifics (c5).

Package and location

- Posted: not stated
- Estimated band: £95,000 - £120,000 per year (midpoint £107,500); London premium 20%
- Location: London; Hybrid; 3 office days per week; The job description says hybrid but gives no number of days; three is assumed from the employer's advertised roles.
- Employer location strategy: Acme Corp has announced regional hubs and plans to hire operations roles there, so pay for this role may drift towards the lower UK-excluding-London level over time.
- Contract effects: The role is permanent, so no contract-basis adjustment applies.

Not scored: context for your decision.

Sources

[S1] Example industry report (illustrative): UK payments industry classification

<https://example.com/reports/uk-payments-industry-classification> accessed 2026-10-04

"Acme Corp and Example Payments Ltd are both classified as payment processors (SIC 66190)."

[S2] Example industry report (illustrative): merchant acquiring competitor landscape

<https://example.com/reports/merchant-acquiring-competitor-landscape> accessed 2026-10-04

"Example Payments Ltd is named as a direct competitor of Acme Corp in UK merchant acquiring."

[S3] Example market share table (illustrative): UK merchant acquiring

<https://example.com/rankings/uk-merchant-acquiring-market-share> accessed 2026-10-04

"Acme Corp is the largest UK merchant acquirer by revenue, 1.2 times the size of its nearest rival."

[S4] Example consulting ranking (illustrative): top 10 firms serving payments

<https://example.com/rankings/top-consulting-firms-payments> accessed 2026-10-04

"Globex Consulting is ranked eighth among consulting firms serving payments and banking clients."

[S5] Example industry report (illustrative): payments market growth forecast

<https://example.com/reports/payments-market-growth-forecast> accessed 2026-10-04

"UK merchant payments processing is forecast to grow by 14.0 per cent a year to 2030."

[S6] Example university groupings (illustrative)

<https://example.com/rankings/uk-universities-groups> accessed 2026-10-04

"The University of Example is a member of the research-intensive Russell Group-style mission group."

[S7] Example news (illustrative): Acme Corp hiring outlook

<https://example.com/news/acme-hiring-outlook> accessed 2026-10-04

"Acme Corp has no hiring freeze and is recruiting across its payments division, with no stated preference for industry insiders."

[S8] Example salary data (illustrative): Head of Operations, London

<https://example.com/salary/head-of-operations-london> accessed 2026-10-04

"Median advertised salary for Head of Operations in London is 115,000 pounds per year."

[S9] Example salary data (illustrative): Head of Operations, UK excluding London

<https://example.com/salary/head-of-operations-uk-excluding-london> accessed 2026-10-04

"Median advertised salary for Head of Operations outside London is 96,000 pounds per year."

[S10] Example salary data (illustrative): Acme Corp operations bands

<https://example.com/careers/acme-operations-bands> accessed 2026-10-04

"Acme Corp advertises senior operations leader roles at 100,000 to 120,000 pounds per year."

[S11] Example salary data (illustrative): Acme Corp regional hubs

<https://example.com/news/acme-regional-hubs> accessed 2026-10-04

"Acme Corp plans to open two regional hubs in the north of England and to hire new operations roles there."